

» IGNEOUS ROCKS



DIORITE
Composed of plagioclase feldspars, with amphiboles and pyroxenes, diorite contains little or no quartz. It is a coarse-grained plutonic rock.



GRANODIORITE
This is probably the most common intrusive igneous rock in the continental crust. It is over 65 per cent plagioclase feldspar.

pale plagioclase feldspar



NEPHELINE SYENITE
Coarse-grained, pale-coloured, and composed of feldspars, micas, and hornblende, this rock also contains nepheline but usually no quartz.



SYENITE
Grey or pinkish, syenite is a plutonic rock that occurs in large intrusions. Coarse-grained, it contains feldspars, micas, and hornblende, and little or no quartz.



LAMPROPHYRE
Lamprophyre's matrix is medium-grained and studded with distinct crystals of micas and amphiboles. It forms in dykes and sills.

LARVIKITE
A form of syenite, larvikite is blue-black in colour and composed of large amounts of feldspar that can have a shimmering blue schiller effect.



GRANITE
Coarse-grained and of varying colour, granite contains more than ten per cent quartz. Attractive when polished, it is often used on the facade of buildings.



GABBRO
This dark, plutonic rock contains plagioclase feldspars, pyroxenes, and olivine. Coarse-grained, it forms from the slow cooling of basaltic magma at depth.

light plagioclase feldspar



LAYERED GABBRO
This type of gabbro shows banding caused by the settling of minerals of different density in the magma.



PORPHYRITIC MICROGRANITE
Larger crystals are set into the matrix of this medium-grained rock, which is composed mainly of quartz, micas, and feldspars.

black tourmaline



WHITE MICROGRANITE

MICROGRANITE
This medium-grained granite – often with a porphyritic texture – occurs in sills and dykes, which are sheets of intrusive igneous rock.



DOLERITE
Typically occurring in sills and dykes, dolerite is a dark, medium-grained rock composed of plagioclase feldspars, pyroxenes, and iron oxides.



BOJITE
A dark-coloured rock, bojite is a general term for hornblende-rich gabbro. It is coarse-grained and forms from magma.